Minutes of the Extraordinary Meeting of the Council of the City of Sheffield held in the Council Chamber, Town Hall, Pinstone Street, Sheffield, S1 2HH, on Wednesday 14 May 2025, at 2.00 pm, pursuant to notice duly given and Summonses duly served.

PRESENT

THE LORD MAYOR (Councillor Jayne Dunn)
THE DEPUTY LORD MAYOR (Councillor Safiya Saeed)

1 *Beauchief & Greenhill Ward*
Simon Clement-Jones
Richard Shaw
Sophie Crossthorn

2 *Beighton Ward*
Kurtis Crossland
Ian Horner

3 *Birley Ward*
Matthew Dwyer
Denise Fox
Karen McGowan

4 *Broomhill & Sharrow Vale Ward*
Angela Argenzio
Maleiki Haybe
Brian Holmshaw

5 *Burngreave Ward*
Talib Hussain
Mark Jones
Safiya Saeed

6 *City Ward*
Douglas Johnson
Ruth Mersereau
Martin Phipps

7 *Crookes & Crosspool Ward*
Tim Huggan
Ruth Milsom
Minesh Parekh

8 *Darnall Ward*
Qais Al-Ahdal
Mary Lea
Zahira Naz

9 *Dore & Totley Ward*
Rebecca Atkinson
Joe Otten
Martin Smith

10 *East Ecclesfield Ward*
Craig Gamble Pugh
Robert Reiss
Alan Woodcock

11 *Ecclesall Ward*
Peter Gilbert
Barbara Masters
Shaffaq Mohammed

12 *Firth Park Ward*
Fran Belbin
Nikki Belfield
Abdul Khayum

13 *Fulwood Ward*
Sue Alston
Andrew Sangar
Cliff Woodcraft

14 *Gleadless Valley Ward*
Alexi Dimond
Marieanne Elliot
Paul Turpin

15 *Graves Park Ward*
Steve Ayris
Rob Bannister
Mohammed Mahroof

16 *Hillsborough Ward*
Christine Gilligan Kubo
Toby Mallinson
Henry Nottage

17 *Manor Castle Ward*
Elle Dodd
Terry Fox
Laura Moynahan

18 *Mosborough Ward*
Glynis Chapman
Tony Downing
Gail Smith

19 *Nether Edge & Sharrow Ward*
Nighat Basharat
Maroof Raouf
Ibby Ullah

20 *Park & Arbourthorne*
Mia Drazaic
Ben Miskell
Nabeela Mowlana

21 *Richmond Ward*
David Barker
Mike Drabble

22 *Shiregreen & Brightside Ward*
Dawn Dale
Mark Rusling
Garry Weatherall

23 *Southey Ward*
Mike Chaplin
Jayne Dunn
Gareth Slater

24 *Stannington Ward*
Penny Baker
William Sapwell
Richard Williams

25 *Stocksbridge & Upper Don Ward*
Janet Ridler
Mark Whittaker

26 *Walkley Ward*
Tom Hunt
Laura McClean
John Wright

27 *West Ecclesfield Ward*
Alan Hooper
Mike Levery
Ann Whitaker

28 *Woodhouse Ward*
Willis Marshall
Alison Norris
Mick Rooney

1. MINUTE'S SILENCE - DEATH OF FORMER COUNCILLOR VIV NICHOLSON

1.1 The Lord Mayor (Councillor Jayne Dunn) reported with sadness, the recent death, on 1st April, 2025, of former Councillor Viv Nicholson, who had served as a Member of the Council from 1983 to 1999, representing the former Park Ward.

1.2 Members of the Council observed a minute's silence in memory of former Councillor Nicholson. After the completion of the business of the meeting, several Members of the Council spoke to pay tribute to her.

2. APOLOGIES FOR ABSENCE

2.1 Apologies for absence were received from Councillors Dianne Hurst and Ann Woolhouse.

3. EXCLUSION OF THE PRESS AND PUBLIC

3.1 There were no items of business identified where resolutions may be moved to exclude the press and public.

4. DECLARATIONS OF INTEREST

4.1 There were no declarations of interest made by Members of the Council.

5. PUBLIC PETITIONS, QUESTIONS AND STATEMENTS RELATING TO THE SHEFFIELD PLAN

5.1 Statement From The Lord Mayor

5.1.1 The Lord Mayor (Councillor Jayne Dunn) read the following statement regarding the Sheffield Plan: Proposed Additional Site Allocations -

"The report being considered by full Council today is about focussed changes to Sheffield's Draft Local Plan – what we refer to as the 'Sheffield Plan'. As you are aware, the report proposes to release land from the Green Belt to provide additional land for new development.

I wanted to take this opportunity to explain clearly:-

- *the background to this issue;*

- *what will happen next if full Council approves the report today; and*

- *how public participations in the meeting today will be managed.*

The Sheffield Plan covers the whole of Sheffield (except the area within the Peak District National Park) and sets out the overall requirement for new development over the 17-year period, 2022 to 2039. It's a legal requirement for all local planning authorities to produce a local plan for their area.

The Plan has already been subject to two rounds of public consultation. Consultation on Issues and Options took place in autumn 2020 and further consultation on the Draft Plan took place in early 2023. The Draft Plan was submitted to the Government in October 2023 for public examination and 3 Inspectors were subsequently appointed by the Government to examine the soundness of the Plan. The tests of soundness are set out in the National Planning Policy Framework.

The Draft Plan proposed 218 hectares of land for employment land and enough land for 34,680 additional homes.

The Plan that was submitted to the Government in October 2023 did not propose any release of greenfield land in the Green Belt for development. The only Green Belt land proposed for release is at the former Norton Aerodrome in the south of the city – a sustainably-located brownfield site.

I make these points now because it is important that everyone understands that these latest proposals, being considered today, are part of a much wider plan, which is focused on the regeneration of the existing urban areas and reuse of brownfield sites. Much of the evidence relating to the urban areas has already been examined by the Inspectors. We must be clear that the consultation on additional sites does not reopen debate about sites that the Inspectors have already considered. The Inspectors will, however, be prepared to look at any new evidence on urban capacity that is put forward.

The Inspectors held a series of public hearings last year into various aspects of the Plan, but they paused the Examination in November because they said that, based on the evidence they had heard up to that point, they had concerns about the supply of employment and housing land proposed in the Plan.

The Inspectors subsequently wrote to the Council in February to formally set out their preliminary conclusions. Whilst they accepted much of the Council's evidence, they considered that both the housing and employment land requirements should be higher than is proposed in the Draft Plan which was submitted in October 2023. Therefore, more land needs to be identified for development.

The report before full Council today is a response to the request of the Inspectors to identify more sites for development.

If full Council approves this report today, the public will have an opportunity to have their say on the proposed additional site allocations. Public consultation on the proposals and the supporting evidence would start on 29th May and run for 6 weeks until 11th July.

All of the consultation responses will be considered by the Inspectors. They will not come back to the Council. The Inspectors would use the responses to the consultation to set agendas for public hearings in the autumn. These public hearings would provide an opportunity for the detailed issues raised in the petitions and questions to full Council today to be fully considered. Anyone seeking a change to the proposed allocations would also be entitled to present further written evidence and/or appear at the hearings.

Once the public hearings have ended, the Inspectors will issue their Preliminary Report which will recommend Main Modifications where they are necessary to make the Plan sound. I would like to stress that this may or may not include some or all of the sites currently being considered.

Any amendments which the Inspector considers are required to make the Plan sound will be the subject of a further period of public consultation – likely to be in early 2026. The Council must then make the recommended Main Modifications if they wish to adopt the Plan. Following receipt of the Inspector's final report, the Plan (including any Main Modifications) will then come back to the full Council to be considered for adoption. This is expected to be around July 2026.

I wanted to take the time to clearly outline the process that will be followed at this meeting today in terms of public participations.

3 petitions have been received. We have also received over 70 public questions and 20 public statements.

We will first hear the 3 petitions. After all 3 petitions have been presented, the Council Leader (Councillor Tom Hunt) will provide a response.

Next, we will allow all questions to be read out. Firstly, we will hear from people who wish to ask their question themselves. Secondly, we will hear the questions from people who have requested for them to be read out on their behalf.

Due to time constraints and the volume of public participations received, Councillor Hunt will not respond individually to each question as it is asked. After all the public questions have been heard, Councillor Hunt will provide a response which will address the main themes that have been raised by the questioners.

Councillor Hunt's response will not engage in detail with specific issues raised relating to individual sites. Matters of detail regarding specific sites will be considered in full by the Inspectors via the consultation process and the subsequent public examination. As part of this process, the Council will be asked by the Inspectors to respond to detailed points via evidence statements

and during the hearing sessions in the autumn.

We will then listen to all the statements, including those where people have asked for them to be read out. This is an important part of the democratic process, giving everyone the opportunity for their statement to be made in a public forum.

We will allow as much time as is needed for all the questions and statements to be read out, and if necessary, we will extend the length of the meeting to accommodate that.

The approach that I have now outlined means that everyone who wishes for their voice to be heard today will be given that opportunity.

I also want to reiterate that there will be further opportunities to raise concerns at consultation events and in written representations during the consultation period."

5.1.2 The Lord Mayor concluded her remarks by asking that, in view of the large volume of public representations received, the petitioners be brief and keep within their time limit of 3 minutes when presenting their petition, and that other participants be as brief as possible when asking their questions or making statements and keep to the content they have submitted in advance of the meeting.

5.2 Petitions

5.2.1 *Petition to stop excessive housing development on green belt land in Ecclesfield*

The Council received an online petition containing approximately 480 signatures, calling on the Council to stop excessive housing development on green belt land in Ecclesfield. The full wording of the petition is published on the Council's website.

The lead petitioner, Andrew Robinson, was present at the meeting but had indicated that he did not wish to speak to make representations upon the petition.

5.2.2 *Petition to stop housing development on Handsworth's Green Belt*

The Council received a paper petition and an online petition containing approximately 3,700 signatures, calling on the Council to stop the housing development on green belt land in Handsworth. The full wording of the petition is published on the Council's website. The lead petitioner was Mark Barnsley.

Representations on behalf of the petitioners were made by Sapphire McCarthy, representing the group 'Opposition to the Removal of Green Belt Land in S13', who stated that the proposed inclusion of the two Green Belt sites in the already

condensed area of S13 represented half of the proposed new housing development in Green Belt in the Local Plan and added that the petitioners feel this is disproportionate and unfair.

Ms. McCarthy referred to the fact that there are Council homes sitting empty and many sites sitting dormant despite having been granted planning permission and the petitioners believe that developers are choosing not to build the homes they potentially could.

She added that the local community were not included in public consultations in 2020 or 2023 and have been denied the chance to respond properly. With nearly 4,000 signatures on the petition opposing these developments, the petitioners were seeking to have the Plan amended.

She stated that the proposed inclusion of two vast sites in the S13 area does not seem to take into consideration the impact of housing development that is due to start in the locality, such as near Medlock Close and at the Waverley site in neighbouring Rotherham. She commented that Appendices 6 and 7 of the Sheffield Plan states that site S02502 would perform a weak role in preventing urban sprawl, thus allowing everywhere from Waverley to Woodhouse to become one massive settlement.

As regards additional infrastructure, she stated that the Handsworth and Retford Roads could not be widened, meaning that traffic and pollution would surely rise, and surrounding roads would become ‘rat-runs’.

She commented that there were 16 sites in Sheffield, the west of Europe’s greenest city, where green space is plentiful, yet the inclusion of those sites into the Local Plan have been rejected, whereas 75% of the suggested green belt sites from the S13 area will be built on.

She stated that site S02502 was added for development despite being likely to have significant ecological value and it requiring further ecology assessment, according to the appendices in the Plan, and that it is also stated that the development of that site would impact the rural character of the landscape.

Ms. McCarthy added that the Plan did include provision for a new secondary school, but none for early years and primary age schoolchildren, despite existing schools and nurseries being oversubscribed.

She added that next week, local children will be participating in Mayor Coppard’s ‘walk to school week’ and will walk on the bridleway that runs along Bramley Lane to both Ballifield and Handsworth Grange Schools. Hundreds of people travelling to these Schools access that bridleway but, according to appendices 6 and 7, that route may be lost to development, forcing children to walk alongside busy roads or travel by car, worsening emissions.

She stated that local residents already struggle to access GP surgeries when they need to and already wait years for a place on registers at dental practices, and are thus already having to live with insufficient local healthcare services,

and she added that the petitioners believe that the Council should be addressing these inadequacies before considering allowing more residents into the area.

She concluded by remarking that although the petitioners have been told that the Planning Inspectors won't give much weight to petitions, the Council can do. Thousands of people elected their local representatives to listen to them and they have made it clear that this Plan is unjust and S13 residents deserve better.

5.2.3 *Petition to protect Green Belt land in Chapeltown from development*

The Council received an online petition containing 1,895 signatures, calling on the Council to protect Green Belt land in Chapeltown from development. The full wording of the petition is published on the Council's website. The lead petitioner was Matthew Pegler.

Representations on behalf of the petitioners were made by Mark Ash, who stated that he lived on Warren Lane which is where a site earmarked for building B2 heavy industrial units is proposed on an adjacent field which surrounds a small community, itself surrounded by beautiful green space which the residents enjoy and also provides a thriving ecosystem which is currently protected by Green Belt and historic woodland, which is now under threat.

He commented that Warren Lane predominantly consists of elderly residents, with a retirement home and special needs properties for adult care in the community, and which rely on the green surroundings for their residents' mental health and wellbeing, and which also currently benefits all the local community.

He stated that not only will the plans decimate the landscape but will also impact the environment, that will never be recovered once cast in concrete which will shadow over local residences forever.

He commented that the land already acts as a buffer zone to the residences in relation to noise from the adjacent M1 motorway and these plans will compound the noise pollution, along with light and air pollution and an increase in CO2, all adding negatively to climate change, which the Council is an advocate for, and contradicting Sheffield's net zero to 2030 goals.

He remarked that the plans will also set a dangerous precedent of mass development, with no Green Belt being safe from developers, affecting Sheffield residents and generations to come.

Mr. Ash added that the plans will also impact the already stressed services and infrastructure in the area, with traffic continually backing up on and around the A616 Tankersley By-Pass and the A6135 White Lane into Chapeltown, which adds at least 20 minutes to any journey during peak times already.

He stated that the petitioners note the unfair distribution of the plans which are condensed in the S35 area, along with the objectional use of Green Belt which

does not meet the National Planning Policy Framework Directive of exceptional circumstances, or the 'Golden Rules', with not all brown belt being surveyed or even considered.

He commented that, due to the lack of publicity and lack of due process and duty of care by the Council, there had been limited time to distribute the petition, yet in a short period of time it had gained over 1,900 signatures, and that this number will vastly increase once the petitioners' plight has been highlighted and more momentum is gained, with Chapeltown being one of the Council's largest voting constituencies.

He concluded by urging the Council to be mindful of the petition and reject these plans and turn the focus on utilising alternative brown belt land, and other areas of Sheffield that are in much greater need of regeneration, and not at the cost of the environment and Green Belt and at the expense of constituents' wellbeing and health.

5.2.4 *Response to the Petitions*

The petitions were referred to Councillor Tom Hunt (Leader of the Council and Chair of the Strategy and Resources Policy Committee) to respond. Councillor Hunt responded in the following terms –

"*Thank you to the petitioners for joining us at the meeting today. I don't underestimate how difficult it can be to come here. It's a fundamental part of our politics – and particularly of the local plan process - that everyone has the right to contribute and we want you to be heard.*

Thank you to everyone who has signed petitions.

I can assure you that the proposals we are considering today about the potential release of Green Belt land is something that none of us take lightly and, indeed, is something that should only be considered in exceptional circumstances.

In my response I'm going to talk about how we've got here today.

I'll talk about our Brownfield First Local Plan, I'll speak about the Golden Rules which set high standards for affordable housing, for essential infrastructure, and for green spaces that will apply to any potential Green Belt development in the future, and I'll say something brief about the implications of not having a Local Plan.

This is an emotive subject, and I do understand the depth of feeling. We'll hear a lot today and everyone will get a chance to have their say. People in Sheffield will always tell you what they think, are fair minded and prepared to listen. The people of Sheffield are at the heart of today's decision.

Sheffield – like the UK – has not been building enough homes for a very long time. As a result -

- *How many of us know adult children living at home with their parents because they can't get a home?*
- *How many of us worry that our children and grandchildren won't be able to enjoy the same opportunities we had?*
- *How many people in their 30s and 40s are stuck renting when they want to get on and may be delaying starting a family?*
- *How many of us know that the place where we live is brilliant but worry that our family won't ever be able to live there too?*

The answer, to all those questions, is lots of us.

We've all heard those concerns from our friends, family and neighbours and from the people we represent. To help to tackle the housing crisis you need to have a plan.

This is what the Local Plan does. It's a plan to allocate land so that the city has the homes and the jobs that we need. A plan to make sure good quality homes are built with the right infrastructure to support communities. A plan for more affordable housing and for more regeneration on brownfield land. A plan for more jobs, to make sure we have sites for employment in a growing economy.

Over the last couple of years all parties in the Council's cross-party administration have been involved in shaping and developing the Plan. A cross-party member working group has met regularly with the Council's Planning officers to guide the progress of the Plan.

I'd like to thank those members of the working group for their work to develop the Plan. From the Liberal Democrat Group, Councillors Mike Levery and Andrew Sangar, from the Green Group, Councillors Christine Gilligan Kubo and Paul Turpin, and from the Labour Group, Councillors Ben Miskell and Fran Belbin. I'd also like to place on record my thanks to the Planning officers for their work.

As the Lord Mayor has set out in her earlier statement, the draft Plan was submitted in 2023 and throughout 2024, the independent Planning Inspectorate examined the Plan in public and considered the public's views.

The Inspectors wrote to us in February to say that Sheffield's housing requirement should be increased by 3,500 additional homes to take the total to just over 38,000 homes. More of us are living longer, more of us are living alone, and we're a growing city. The Inspectors also consider that the amount of employment land should be increased.

At this point, let us be clear that the draft Plan submitted to examiners is a Brownfield First Plan. A brownfield first plan that didn't propose any greenfield land in the Green Belt for development.

The overwhelming majority of new homes proposed, and virtually all the employment land are on brownfield sites. 18,000 homes are on brownfield land in the city centre.

I know that lots of people will look at former industrial sites or empty plots in the city today and think that homes should be built on them. I walk and drive around the city and see them too.

The reality is that lots of them are being earmarked for housebuilding and employment in the Plan, which means they will be built on over the lifetime of the Plan, up to 2039. So much so that there are no more available bits of brownfield land left to allocate for housing or employment. On that basis, the independent Inspectors think that exceptional circumstances could exist to justify the release of some Green Belt land in Sheffield. However, the Council's Planning team, rightly so, have to explore all other alternatives first.

The Inspectors asked us to review the housing capacity of the existing urban areas again to see if there's any further scope for more development.

The Planning officers have done that, by reviewing urban capacity – the conclusion is clear; we have allocated all the brownfield sites that have been promoted to us.

The Inspectors accepted that there is also a supply of unallocated brownfield land that will deliver a high level of windfall development. Windfalls are developments that come forward as planning applications on sites that are not allocated in the Plan.

Neighbouring local authorities were also spoken with, to see if they could take additional homes. They couldn't.

Planning officers have also looked at whether we could increase housing densities on sites. Planners believe that the density calculations that have been applied to both housing and employment sites in the Plan are realistic and protect the character of the city, i.e. we're not just going to build tall towers that don't fit in. We also won't just build tiny box homes that are no good for families.

All of this means that we are in the exceptional circumstances where to provide the number of homes that the city needs, we are being asked to look at green belt sites. This is something I don't take lightly; it's something none of us take lightly.

A rigorous selection process involving Labour, Liberal Democrat and Green councillors has taken place to identify sites, and details of the selection process have been published today (14/5/25).

While the biggest number of new homes are to be built in the city centre, we do recognise that there isn't an even distribution of proposed sites in the Green Belt in all areas of the city. As we review the Plan, we will look at the potential to bring forward sites in other areas of the city – with a fair distribution across the city so that we can maximise the potential to deliver affordable housing in higher value areas like on the west of the city.

What we can confirm is that any Green Belt land that is considered for development, will be taken forward under strict Golden Rules introduced by the Labour government. The Golden Rules set high standards for affordable housing, for essential infrastructure, and for green spaces.

We will apply all the Golden Rules for each site in full.

- *Golden Rule 1 – Sites must have affordable homes that are available to all. We don't want people to be priced out of their area.*

The Local Plan already sets out a requirement for all housing developments in the southwest, south and northwest of the city to have 30% affordable housing in those developments. There will be a 10% requirement in housing developments in all other areas. But on former Green Belt land, we will expect even more affordable housing to be delivered, homes that people can afford.

- *Golden Rule 2 - New infrastructure will be delivered at the same time as the new homes and employment developments.*

Let us be crystal clear - not homes first, infrastructure second, but homes and infrastructure together to support communities.

We will ensure there is good public transport and road improvements, improvements to schools and healthcare facilities like GP surgeries. Where sixth form provision is needed, we will argue for it.

We are bringing our buses back under public control so that we can design the routes that communities need, not have the routes that the bus companies want to run. We are making plans to expand our tram network so that new homes will be near to new tram lines that we are planning to run through the upper Don Valley to Stocksbridge and through South East Sheffield on the Barrow Hill Line.

We will upgrade road junctions near to new developments, particularly in the north and southeast of the city and we know that the Council needs to take steps with partners like Highways England to tackle congestion, including at M1 junctions, in the Lower Don Valley and in the A57 Crystal Peaks area.

- *Golden Rule 3 – Sites will have good access to green spaces. All new development is now subject to rules that mean that developers must demonstrate at least a 10% increase in biodiversity – either on the site itself, or by providing new wildlife habitats elsewhere.*

Conditions are attached to the potential site allocations to ensure that important features, such as streams, hedgerows and green corridors, are protected and continue to provide access to nature.

All of us here today know how important green spaces are for you and for communities across Sheffield. We all understood the value of green spaces during the pandemic. I'm proud that Sheffield has more green spaces than any

other major city apart from Oslo. That's why we are going to protect it. Only a very small amount of the Green Belt is being considered for release. The sites being considered would remove 3.6% of the total Green Belt, which means that the Local Plan would protect over 96% of the Green Belt (and the part of Sheffield in the Peak District National Park).

The stakes are high. If more land is not provided, it is almost certain that the Sheffield Plan will be found unsound, and the Council would be asked to withdraw the Plan and start work on an entirely new Plan. This would need to be submitted to the Government by December 2026 at the latest.

Any new Plan would need to use new national methodology which would increase Sheffield's housing requirement to 2,390 new homes per year - over 150 more homes per year than is currently being proposed by the Inspectors. That would equate to over 40,600 homes over what would be a new 17-year period.

A new Plan would also need us to look further ahead, perhaps to 2042 and, by the time a new Plan could be produced, more brownfield sites in the city would have been used up. All of these factors would likely mean that more Green Belt sites would have to be released than is currently being proposed today.

Without a Local Plan, the city would be vulnerable to speculative applications on Green Belt and greenfield sites. Unplanned development in the wrong places. None of us want to see that.

It's a fundamental and important principle of our planning system that residents have their say and I encourage people to share their views.

As the Lord Mayor has said in her earlier statement, if Full Council approves this report today, the public will have an opportunity to have their say on the proposed additional sites allocations.

If the report is approved, there will be a 6-week public consultation from May 29th. There will then be public hearings in the autumn. If the Inspectors support all or some of the proposed site allocations, there will then be a further period of consultation early in the new year.

Any sites that are included in the adopted Plan will still also need to go through the process of obtaining planning permission.

Development on Green Belt sites will not get built quickly. It's likely that the largest housing sites would not see any homes completed before 2030 or 2031. They would be built out over a number of years, allowing time to bring forward the necessary infrastructure. Allowing time for masterplans for the largest sites to be developed with further input from the public.

Planning applications provide a further opportunity for residents to have their say. If developments are not of good quality and don't meet the Golden Rules, then they won't go ahead.

It is so important that people have their say. Today is the start of that process, not the end. There are lots of people with questions who have come here today to ask them, and I have been clear that everyone who is here should be able to have their say and be heard. We want to hear from all of you so that information can be shared and answers can be provided and all Councillors present can hear your views."

5.3 Public Questions

5.3.1 Questions were asked by Christopher Pennell, Sadie Charlton (attending remotely), Adele Riddle, Mark Cockayne, Richard Nutbrown, Lorraine Mellor, Margaret Lea, Susan Housley, Yvonne McCarthy-Brown, Andrew Robinson, Stuart Keen (read on his behalf by Bec Nutton), Stephanie Oliver-Beech (read on her behalf by Lorraine Mellor), Pauline Andrews (read on her behalf by Cheryl Hall), Jonathan Rhodes (read on his behalf by Bec Nutton), and Christine Bennett (read on her behalf by Mark Barlow). The full content of their questions is published on the Council's website.

5.3.2 (NOTE: At this point in the proceedings, it was **RESOLVED:** On the motion moved by the Lord Mayor (Councillor Jayne Dunn), seconded by the Deputy Lord Mayor (Councillor Safiya Saeed), that, in accordance with Council Procedure Rule 15.1(c), the one hour time period for public questions, statements and petitions be extended to allow for all remaining public contributions to be made.)

5.3.3 Questions were read out by either the Chief Executive or the General Counsel on behalf of Elizabeth Sadiq, Matthew Sieczkarek, Lynne Swindells, Paul Manning, Megan Tory, Emma Smith, Rebecca Allen, Aftab Sadiq, Iwona Zwierzak, Stella Harding, Jon Baggaley, Susan Smelt, Adam Bishop, Lindy Hinchliffe, Claire Pennington, Claire Elliott, Susan Atack, Alison Anderson, Sarah Ward, Nigel Dorman, James Goodwin, Lindsey Hudson, Andrew Webster, Graham Oliver-Beech, Matthew McCarthy, Jim Hobson, Rebecca Johnston, Nicola Oates and Jane Williams. The full content of their questions is published on the Council's website.

5.3.4 Questions had also been received from the following members of the public who were not in attendance at the meeting – Hayley Smith, Rachel Green, Mandy Surradge, Helen Weston, Karen Riley, Daniel Clark, Paul Jannaway, Liz Glover, Lisa Porter, John Porter, Charles Moonstone, Kay Dyche, Elaine Staite, Christopher Staite, Anja Charlesworth, Camille Chapman, Caron Chapman, James Tomlinson, Thomas Martel, Glen Charlesworth, Jenni Wagstaff, Phil Harris, Dawn Stevens and Laura Cavill. The full content of their questions is published on the Council's website.

5.3.5 Councillor Tom Hunt (Leader of the Council and Chair of the Strategy and Resources Policy Committee) provided a response to all the questions, in the following terms –

“Thank you to everyone who has taken the time to ask a question today or to submit a question. As I said earlier in my response to the petitions – it is vitally important that everyone has the opportunity to contribute, and everyone has the right for their views to be heard.

A lot of people have taken up that opportunity today and I want to thank you for your patience while you’ve waited for everyone’s questions to be asked. With so many members of the public wanting to contribute today there was no perfect way to manage this process but I’m grateful to all attendees for bearing with us while we’ve heard from everyone.

I am going to provide a response that covers as many of the questions that have been asked as I can. Written responses will be provided after the meeting to everyone who has submitted a question.

But, as the Lord Mayor said in her introduction earlier, I will not be able to engage in detail with specific issues raised relating to individual sites. This is because matters of detail regarding specific sites will be considered in full by the Inspectors via the consultation process and the subsequent public examination that would take place should a decision be taken later at this meeting to move to that stage.

As part of this process, the Council will be asked by the Inspectors to respond to detailed points, such as the type raised in the public questions, via evidence statements and during the public hearing sessions which will likely take place in the autumn.

I want to say clearly that I fully understand the depth of public feeling about the matters under consideration at this meeting today and I understand how precious Sheffield’s green spaces are, for the city’s identity as a whole but also for individual households and communities.

I want to reiterate my earlier statement that we are in exceptional circumstances where, to provide the number of homes that the city needs and sufficient employment land, we are being asked to look at green belt sites.

We do not take this decision lightly, and we know how much it matters that we get this right for our city, for now and for in the future.

Sheffield doesn’t currently have a Local Plan. Without one, we are left wide open to unplanned development. This means that we have less control over where development happens and when it happens, and we have less power to challenge developers who may want to build on sites that we don’t think are suitable.

Sheffield cannot continue not to have a Local Plan. It is not sustainable for us to avoid making difficult decisions.

So, although I understand that this is really hard, I also believe that it is necessary.

For too long, the UK has not been building enough homes each year. This has created a housing crisis. Everyone should have access to a safe and secure home that they are able to call their own. We want to ensure that we increase the supply of affordable homes in the city, because we cannot tackle the housing crisis without building more good quality homes.

In relation to points raised about brownfield land, the Local Plan has been developed as a 'brownfield-first' plan. The vast majority of new homes and employment land are planned on brownfield sites. Sheffield has been successful at developing brownfield land over the last 40 years, which means that the local Green Belt has been largely untouched for 40 years.

I know, and we have heard this at the meeting today, that people feel incredibly strongly about the potential loss of any green belt and I understand that. If I thought that there was a viable way forward, as an alternative to putting forward these sites on the green belt, then this report to be considered here today would not be here.

The current proposals mean that 96.4% of the local Green Belt will remain untouched and protected if the Local Plan progresses.

In relation to questions about site selection, there has been a detailed paper prepared and published with the agenda for today's meeting which provides information on that issue.

I said earlier that I do recognise that there isn't an even distribution of proposed sites in the green belt in all areas of the city. We are looking at a range of sites that have been suggested to the Council, sites that are available, sites that are deemed to be sustainable, and sites that, for example, are close to public transport networks. We are looking at sites on the West of the city. I am committed that, as we review the plan, we will look at the potential to bring forward sites in other areas of the city – with a fair distribution across the city - and so that we can maximise the potential to deliver affordable housing in higher value areas, like on the west of the city.

A lot of people have asked about how communities will be engaged and whether there will be public meetings.

As mentioned earlier, the meeting today represents the start of the consultation process. I want to reassure you that there will be a series of 'drop-in' sessions in areas across the city where officers will be available to answer questions and provide more information.

Dates for all these events will be published on the Sheffield Plan webpage as soon as possible once dates and venues have been confirmed and following a decision to proceed being taken today. The events will be publicised through the Local Area Committees and online and all organisations who are registered on the Local Plan mailing list will be sent those details.

I want to be clear that this is very much the start of the consultation and public engagement process and there will be many more opportunities for everyone who wants to do so to have their say.

Many of you have raised concerns about the impact of the proposals on biodiversity, nature and wildlife.

The Council's Ecology Service has provided advice to Planning Officers as part of the site selection process and that professional advice has been included in the proposals being considered today.

We recognise that virtually all development land (including many brownfield sites) will have some wildlife present, but all the proposed sites will be subject to national requirements for Biodiversity Net Gain. Conditions will also be attached to many of the proposed allocations to ensure that important features such as streams, hedgerows and green corridors are protected as part of the layout of the development.

Where the site adjoins a Local Designated Wildlife Site, conditions have been attached which require a 'buffer strip' of green space to be provided between the wildlife site and any land that can potentially be built on.

Regarding points that have been raised about traffic congestion and transport infrastructure, the Local Plan Transport Assessment has been updated to take into account the proposed additional site allocations.

Part of that assessment looks at whether road junctions have the capacity to accommodate any extra movement of vehicles that could be generated by a new development. Where any capacity issues at a junction could arise, measures are being drawn up to improve the traffic flow. Details of the junctions requiring improvement will be set out in the updated Infrastructure Delivery Plan which will be available as part of the public consultation.

The draft allocations have also been selected on the basis of their proximity to public transport and/or local facilities - this helps to encourage trips by means other than having to rely on the private car.

We know that public transport is not good enough. And this is why a decision was taken in March this year to bring local buses back under public control. Franchising will provide opportunities to look at the frequency of services and new routes to ensure that housing developments are supported by public transport.

Whenever any developer prepares a planning application for a site, they will have to produce a detailed Transport Assessment, which may identify further requirements for mitigation measures.

The additional demand that the residents of these new developments would place upon local services has been looked at within the Infrastructure Delivery Plan Update. It is worth noting that part of the reason why services are so

stretched is because for the last 14 years we have had governments that have underinvested in our public services, including vital services such as GP surgeries. The Infrastructure Delivery Plan Update has been informed by discussions with service providers, including the Sheffield Integrated Care Board and the Council's Education Service. Where any additional homes may result in the need for new or improved facilities, contributions will be required to address the additional demand. This could be in the form of land or a financial contribution.

I want to reiterate that, as part of the Golden Rules that will be applied to any proposed Green Belt sites, it is vitally important that the new homes and new infrastructure come forward together. The Council will make sure that any necessary new infrastructure is delivered alongside the new homes – not homes first, infrastructure second, but delivered together to support communities.

In terms of specifics, the Education Service has identified a potential need for 2 new secondary schools in the city (one in the north of the city and one in the south east of the city) and land is being proposed to be allocated for those schools. A new SEND school is also proposed on land south of The Wheel between Ecclesfield and Grenoside.

Primary school needs can be met by existing schools because the number of primary age children is forecast to reduce in the time that most of the new homes are built. Demographic changes mean that there is currently an above average number of primary age children, but that is forecast to decrease.

Discussions with the Sheffield Integrated Care Board are on-going and any identified needs for new health services would be included in the Infrastructure Delivery Plan update, but, crucially, the Integrated Care Board anticipate that any additional needs can be catered for through expansion of existing facilities.

It is also worth emphasising that the development upon any sites proposed in the Green Belt would not be built all at once. The developments are some years away and it's unlikely that the largest housing sites would deliver any completed homes before 2030 or 2031. They would be built out over a number of years, allowing time for infrastructure to be brought forward as well. One of the benefits of having a Local Plan is that we can be really clear with developers about what the infrastructure requirements would be for particular sites. This is currently not the case.

Some people have asked why the Council has offered sites for both employment and housing that increase the supply of employment land and the supply of homes by more than was requested by the Planning Inspector. This is a precautionary measure to provide a safeguard in case any of the sites, for any reason, do not go ahead.

New evidence may come to light during the consultation and public examination process which could lead the Inspectors to reject a proposed allocation or reduce the site capacity. If that happens, and insufficient supply is identified,

the whole Local Plan would be at risk of potentially being found unsound. We have therefore, on planning advice, allowed an additional margin over and above what was asked by the Planning Inspectors to reduce the risk of that happening.

With regards to questions about flood risk, developable areas have been adjusted to take account of areas that should remain undeveloped for flood risk reasons. The Strategic Flood Risk Assessment has been updated in consultation with the Environment Agency and, where necessary, conditions have been attached to sites.

Based on the results, we are confident that any risk of flooding will be able to be effectively mitigated at the planning application stage.

The updated Strategic Flood Risk Assessment includes a detailed flood risk screening report for every site.

With regards to questions about the scoring methodology used in the assessment of Green Belt land, a Topic Paper has been produced which sets out how the sites have been selected and their scores assessed against the purposes of Green Belts. This is attached as Appendix 7 of the report submitted to this meeting.

Those scores have also been made available on the Sheffield Plan Examination webpage.

With regards to questions from individual land users and owners, officers have used the land ownership information provided by the site promoters who put forward the site for inclusion in the Sheffield Plan, as is normal practice.

In this case, the site promoters' have reconfirmed that all landowners concerned were aware and engaged in the proposal to promote the site for an employment allocation, as part of the Local Plan process.

I would strongly encourage landowners to make their position clear during the public consultation process, so that any new information can be taken into account by the Inspectors.

In response to questions that have been asked about Compulsory Purchase Powers, the Council does not believe it will be necessary to use Compulsory Purchase Powers to acquire land in the Green Belt. Based on the information that has been provided by site promoters, we believe that all the sites are capable of being brought forward without the use of these powers.

But just to reiterate, if anyone has new information about land ownership that comes to light now or as part of the public consultation, the Inspectors will take that into account in deciding whether the site should be allocated, or if an amendment to the site boundary is needed.

In relation to the issues that have been raised about empty homes, we are

taking steps to bring empty homes back into use. We've introduced Council Tax Premiums for both second homes and long-term empty homes. If anyone knows of any homes that are long-term empty, please do contact your local councillor or the planning team. We are also turning round void properties from the Council's own housing stock much quicker.

Questioners have asked how plans have been shaped in order to support communities. All sites will have the Golden Rules applied to them to ensure that every site provides a high level of affordable housing, access to green spaces and infrastructure coming forward together with the new homes.

Thank you again to everyone who has taken the time today to contribute to this discussion. You have conveyed clearly your depth of feeling about the areas that you know and love and I understand your concerns.

Thank you also for your patience while I have provided my response. I have tried to address the main issues that have been raised. All questioners will also receive a written response after the meeting.

The last thing I want to restate is that this is the start of the public engagement process and there will be many more opportunities for people to have their say."

5.4 Public Statements

5.4.1 Statements were read out by Julie Harris and by Sadie Charlton (attending remotely). The full content of their statements is published on the Council's website.

5.4.2 Statements were read out by either the Chief Executive or the General Counsel on behalf of Jess Doncaster, Alison Thompson, Elizabeth Sadiq, Helen Harper, Rebecca Tomlinson, Kerry Hicks, Rosie Wood, Tania Webster, Sharron Needham, David Thornton and Alison Bryce. The full content of their statements is published on the Council's website.

5.4.3 Statements had also been received from the following members of the public who were not in attendance at the meeting – Hayley Smith, Alice Ord, Val Murphy, Abbie Parker, Rob Barber, Diana Radford, Katie Barber and Mark Ash. The full content of their statements is published on the Council's website.

5.4.4 The Lord Mayor (Councillor Jayne Dunn) acknowledged the receipt of the statements from members of the public and expressed her thanks to the public in attendance at the meeting for their patience and exemplary conduct during this item of business.

6. MEMBERS' QUESTIONS RELATING TO URGENT BUSINESS

6.1 The Lord Mayor (Councillor Jayne Dunn) reported that there were no questions relating to urgent business, submitted under the provisions of Council Procedure Rule 16.6.

7. MEMBERSHIPS OF COUNCIL BODIES, REPRESENTATIVES TO SERVE ON OTHER BODIES AND RELATED ISSUES

7.1 On the motion formally moved by Councillor Mary Lea and formally seconded by Councillor Joe Otten, it was:-

RESOLVED UNANIMOUSLY: That:-

(a) it be noted that, in accordance with the authority given by the City Council at its annual meeting held on 15th May 2024, the Monitoring Officer had authorised the appointment of Councillor Angela Argenzio as an additional substitute member of the Waste and Street Scene Policy Committee, with effect from 25th March 2025;

(b) it be noted that (i) the Senior Officer Employment Sub-Committee, at its meeting held on 25th February 2025, appointed Jonathan Clifton to the post of Director of Strategy and Communications, within Strategic and Enabling Services; (ii) the salary package is within the Pay Policy for 2025/26 approved by the Council at its meeting on 5th March 2025 and (iii) Mr. Clifton will start in post on 19th May 2025;

(c) it be noted that (i) the Senior Officer Employment Sub-Committee, at its meeting held on 28th March 2025, appointed Matt Bowsher as Interim Strategic Director of Adults Care and Wellbeing; (ii) the salary package agreed for the role is £25,960 per month, with an expected tenure of 6 months pending recruitment to the permanent role and (iii) Mr. Bowsher started in post on 28th April 2025; and

(d) it be noted that (i) in line with the Pay Policy 2025/26, and following consultation with the Chair of the Senior Officer Employment Committee, the Chief Executive has agreed that a new temporary Deputy Chief Officer post be created, that being the Director of Transformation – Housing, to sit within Neighbourhood Services, and report to the Executive Director of Neighbourhood Services; (ii) the salary package agreed for the role is £130,000 fte per annum; and (iii) Chris Ellison will transfer from the role of Interim Director of Housing to the Interim Director of Transformation – Housing, and will start in the new role on 1st June 2025.

8. SHEFFIELD PLAN - PROPOSED ADDITIONAL SITE ALLOCATIONS AND UPDATES TO THE EVIDENCE BASE

8.1 On the motion moved by Councillor Tom Hunt, seconded by Councillor Douglas Johnson, and after contributions from 25 other Members, and a right of reply from Councillor Hunt, it was:-

RESOLVED: That, in accordance with the recommendations in the report of the Executive Director, City Futures, in relation to the Sheffield Plan, this Council:-

(a) notes the Inspectors' preliminary view in their letter that the plan cannot be found sound in its current form, given their concerns in relation to the housing and employment land need and supply;

(b) notes the temporary pause in the examination to allow the Council to provide the additional information requested within the specified timescale, so that the examination can recommence;

(c) accepts the Inspectors' conclusions in relation to housing need and agrees that additional housing sites should be brought forward to provide 3,539 homes (the minimum number requested by the Inspectors);

(d) accepts the Inspectors' conclusions in relation to employment land need and agrees that additional employment sites should be brought forward to provide 52.8 hectares land (the minimum amount requested by the Inspectors);

(e) agrees that exceptional circumstances now exist to justify the release of greenfield land in Green Belt for new development;

(f) agrees the list of proposed additional site allocations to be presented to the Inspector for both employment and housing land (as set out in Appendix 2);

(g) notes that the list of proposed additional site allocations provides an additional margin above the minimum amounts requested by the Inspectors which is to provide flexibility and reduce risk (as set out in paragraph 3.11 of the report to the Strategy and Resources Policy Committee on 30th April 2025) (Appendix 1 of this report);

(h) notes that the evidence base/submission documents have been/are being updated to reflect the proposed additional site allocations (as well as to address certain other concerns raised during Examination) and that this evidence as updated will be submitted to the Examination at the same time as the proposed additional site allocations;

(i) agrees to the proposed public consultation strategy (Appendix 6) on the information to be submitted, and for the results/responses of the public consultation to be submitted directly to the Inspector's thereafter, alongside the additional/updated information;

(j) agrees the amendment to the Consultation Document (Appendix 2) as detailed in paragraph 2.8 of this report; and

(k) delegates authority to the Head of Planning, in consultation with the Administration group leaders, to approve amendments to the Consultation Strategy and/or Consultation Document prior to the start of public consultation.

8.1.1 The votes on the Motion were ordered to be recorded and were as follows:-

For the Motion (45)	-	The Deputy Lord Mayor (Councillor Safiya Saeed) and Councillors Matthew Dwyer, Karen McGowan, Angela Argenzio, Maleiki Haybe, Brian Holmshaw, Talib Hussain, Mark Jones, Douglas Johnson, Ruth Mersereau, Martin Phipps, Ruth Milsom, Minesh Parekh, Mary Lea, Zahira Naz, Peter Gilbert, Fran Belbin, Nikki Belfield, Abdul Khayum, Alexi Dimond, Marieanne Elliot, Paul Turpin, Rob Bannister, Christine Gilligan Kubo, Toby Mallinson, Henry Nottage, Elle Dodd, Laura Moynahan, Tony Downing, Nighat Basharat, Ibby Ullah, Mia Drazaic, Ben Miskell, Nabeela Mowlana, David Barker, Mike Drabble, Dawn Dale, Mark Rusling, Mike Chaplin, Gareth Slater, Janet Ridler, Mark Whittaker, Tom Hunt, Laura McClean and John Wright.
Against the Motion (31)	-	Councillors Simon Clement-Jones, Richard Shaw, Sophie Crossthorn, Kurtis Crossland, Ian Horner, Denise Fox, Tim Huggan, Qais Al-Ahdal, Rebecca Atkinson, Joe Otten, Martin Smith, Robert Reiss, Alan Woodcock, Barbara Masters, Shaffaq Mohammed, Sue Alston, Andrew Sangar, Cliff Woodcraft, Steve Ayris, Mohammed Mahroof, Terry Fox, Glynis Chapman, Gail Smith, Garry Weatherall, Penny Baker, Will Sapwell, Richard Williams, Alan Hooper, Mike Levery, Ann Whitaker and Willis Marshall.
Abstained from voting on the Motion (4)	-	The Lord Mayor (Councillor Jayne Dunn) and Councillors Craig Gamble Pugh, Alison Norris and Mick Rooney.

8.2 (NOTES: 1. During the consideration of the above item, at the point where contributions had been made from five of the 25 other Members, it was **RESOLVED:** On the motion moved by Councillor Ruth Milsom, seconded by

Councillor Joe Otten, that, in accordance with Council Procedure Rules 4 (Suspension and Amendment of Council Procedure Rules) and 11 (Motions which may be moved without notice), Council Procedure Rule 17.6 be suspended so as to remove the 25-minute time limit for debate on the item of business, to allow for contributions to be made by all Members who wished to speak on the item; and

2. During the consideration of the above item, at the point where contributions had been made from 20 of the 25 other Members, it was **RESOLVED:** On the motion moved by Councillor Mary Lea, seconded by Councillor Joe Otten, that, in accordance with Council Procedure Rules 4 (Suspension and Amendment of Council Procedure Rules) and 11 (Motions which may be moved without notice), Council Procedure Rule 5.6 be suspended and the termination of the meeting be extended to allow for contributions to be made by the remaining five Members who had indicated to the Lord Mayor that they wished to speak on the item.)